

High School ELA – Spanish Glossary Bilingual Content Vocabulary Resource · Grades 9–12

About This Resource: This bilingual glossary was designed to support high school multilingual learners accessing grade-level ELA content. Entries are organized into two sections: content vocabulary and academic vocabulary, each including an English definition, a contextualized example, and a Spanish translation with definition. At the high school level, both sections carry significant weight: students must command complex literary terminology while simultaneously navigating the academic language demands of analytical writing.

Design decisions were grounded in comprehensible input theory and sheltered instruction best practices: definitions use accessible language without oversimplifying content-area concepts, examples draw from texts students commonly encounter in high school ELA, and Spanish translations mirror English sentence structure to support cross-linguistic transfer and metalinguistic awareness.

High School ELA – Spanish Glossary

Content Vocabulary - Spanish

Word	Definition	Example	Spanish Word	Spanish Definition
Allegory	A story, poem, or picture that can be interpreted to reveal a hidden meaning, typically a moral or political one.	George Orwell's Animal Farm is an allegory for the Russian Revolution.	Alegoría	Una historia, poema o imagen que se puede interpretar para revelar un significado oculto, típicamente moral o político.
Alliteration	The repetition of the same initial consonant sound in closely connected words.	"Peter Piper picked a peck of pickled peppers."	Aliteración	La repetición del mismo sonido consonante inicial en palabras cercanas entre sí.
Allusion	A reference to a well-known person, place, event, or work of art or literature.	"He was a real Romeo with the ladies."	Alusión	Una referencia a una persona, lugar, evento u obra de arte o literatura bien conocidos.
Analogy	A comparison between two things to show their similarities, often for explanation or clarification.	"Finding a good man is like finding a needle in a haystack."	Analogía	Una comparación entre dos cosas para mostrar sus similitudes, a menudo para explicación o aclaración.

Anecdote	A short and amusing or interesting story about a real incident or person.	A speaker tells a funny personal story to start their speech.	Anecdota	Una historia corta y divertida o interesante sobre un incidente o persona real.
Antagonist	A character or force in conflict with the protagonist.	Darth Vader in Star Wars.	Antagonista	Un personaje o fuerza en conflicto con el protagonista.
Argument	A reason or set of reasons given to persuade others that an action or idea is right or wrong.	"Social media improves communication."	Argumento	Una razón o conjunto de razones dadas para persuadir a otros de que una acción o idea es correcta o incorrecta.
Assonance	The repetition of vowel sounds in nearby words.	"The rain in Spain falls mainly in the plains."	Asonancia	La repetición de sonidos de vocales en palabras cercanas.
Bias	A tendency to favor one side or opinion over another in an unfair way.	A news article only presenting one side of a political debate.	Sesgo	Una tendencia a favorecer un lado u opinión sobre otro de manera injusta.
Central Idea	The main point or message that an author is trying to convey in a text.	In To Kill a Mockingbird, a central idea is racial injustice.	Idea Central	El punto principal o mensaje que un autor intenta transmitir en un texto.
Characterization	The process by which an author reveals the	Through dialogue and actions, the author	Caracterización	El proceso mediante el cual un autor revela la personalidad de un

	personality of a character, either directly or indirectly.	shows the character's bravery.		personaje, ya sea de forma directa o indirecta.
Claim	A statement that asserts something to be true, often supported by evidence.	"Electric cars are better for the environment."	Reclamación	Una declaración que afirma que algo es verdadero, a menudo respaldada por evidencia.
Climax	The most intense, exciting, or important point in a story, typically a turning point.	The final battle scene in The Avengers.	Clímax	El punto más intenso, emocionante o importante de una historia, típicamente un punto de inflexión.
Connotation	The emotional or cultural meaning associated with a word, beyond its literal definition.	"Home" (suggests warmth and family).	Connotación	El significado emocional o cultural asociado a una palabra, más allá de su definición literal.
Conflict	A struggle between opposing forces, often the main problem in a story.	Man vs. Society in The Hunger Games.	Conflicto	Una lucha entre fuerzas opuestas, a menudo el problema principal en una historia.
Consonance	The repetition of consonant sounds within or at the end of words.	"The lumpy, bumpy road."	Consonancia	La repetición de sonidos consonantes dentro o al final de las palabras.

Counterclaim	A claim made to rebut or argue against a previous claim.	If the claim is "Social media harms communication," the counterclaim is "Social media improves communication."	Contraargumento	Un argumento presentado para refutar o argumentar en contra de una reclamación anterior.
Diction	The choice and use of words and phrases in speech or writing.	A formal essay uses formal diction, while dialogue in a novel may use slang.	Dicción	La elección y uso de palabras y frases en el habla o la escritura.
Dramatic Irony	When the audience knows something that the characters do not.	In Romeo and Juliet, the audience knows Juliet is alive, but Romeo does not.	Ironía Dramática	Cuando la audiencia sabe algo que los personajes no.
Epiphany	A sudden realization or insight experienced by a character.	The moment when a character realizes the true nature of a situation.	Epifanía	Una realización o comprensión repentina experimentada por un personaje.
Ethos	A rhetorical appeal to ethics, character, or credibility to persuade an audience.	A doctor giving medical advice based on their expertise.	Éthos	Un recurso retórico que apela a la ética, carácter o credibilidad para persuadir a una audiencia.
Evidence	Information or details from a text that support a claim or analysis.	Quotes, statistics, facts.	Evidencia	Información o detalles de un texto que apoyan una reclamación o análisis.

Figurative Language	Language that uses figures of speech, such as metaphors, similes, and personification.	"The clouds danced across the sky."	Lenguaje Figurativo	Lenguaje que utiliza figuras retóricas, como metáforas, símiles y personificación.
Flashback	A scene set in a time earlier than the main story.	A character remembers their childhood in a novel.	Flashback	Una escena ambientada en un tiempo anterior a la historia principal.
Foreshadowing	A literary device that gives hints about events that will happen later in the story.	In Of Mice and Men, the killing of Candy's dog foreshadows later events.	Presagio	Un recurso literario que da pistas sobre eventos que sucederán más tarde en la historia.
Hyperbole	Exaggerated statements or claims not meant to be taken literally.	"I'm so hungry I could eat a horse!"	Hipérbole	Declaraciones o afirmaciones exageradas que no deben tomarse literalmente.
Imagery	Descriptive language that appeals to the senses (sight, sound, smell, touch, taste).	"The sweet scent of roses filled the air."	Imágenes	Lenguaje descriptivo que apela a los sentidos (vista, sonido, olfato, tacto, gusto).
Inference	A conclusion drawn from evidence and reasoning.	Inferring that a character is angry because they slam the door.	Inferencia	Una conclusión extraída de evidencia y razonamiento.
Irony	A contrast between expectation and reality.	A pilot has a fear of heights.	Ironía	Un contraste entre la expectativa y la realidad.

Juxtaposition	The placement of two contrasting elements next to each other for effect.	A character's innocence contrasted with the harsh reality of the world around them.	Yuxtaposición	La colocación de dos elementos contrastantes uno al lado del otro para efecto.
Logos	A rhetorical appeal to logic or reason to persuade an audience.	Using statistics to support an argument about climate change.	Logos	Un recurso retórico que apela a la lógica o razón para persuadir a una audiencia.
Metaphor	A figure of speech that compares two unlike things by saying one is the other.	"Time is a thief."	Metáfora	Una figura retórica que compara dos cosas diferentes diciendo que una es la otra.
Mood	The feeling or atmosphere that a writer creates for the reader.	A dark and eerie mood in a gothic novel.	Estado de Ánimo	La sensación o atmósfera que un escritor crea para el lector.
Narrative	A story or account of events or experiences.	A personal narrative about overcoming obstacles.	Narrativa	Una historia o relato de eventos o experiencias.
Oxymoron	A figure of speech in which two opposite ideas are joined to create an effect.	"Bittersweet," "Deafening silence."	Oxímoron	Una figura retórica en la que se unen dos ideas opuestas para crear un efecto.

Paradox	A statement that seems contradictory but reveals a deeper truth.	"Less is more."	Paradoja	Una declaración que parece contradictoria pero revela una verdad más profunda.
Pathos	A rhetorical appeal to emotion to persuade an audience.	A charity commercial showing images of suffering animals to elicit sympathy.	Patos	Un recurso retórico que apela a la emoción para persuadir a una audiencia.
Personification	Giving human characteristics to non-human things or animals.	"The wind whispered through the trees."	Personificación	Atribuir características humanas a cosas no humanas o animales.
Plot	The sequence of events in a story, including exposition, rising action, climax, and resolution.	A mystery novel's plot follows the detective solving a crime.	Trama	La secuencia de eventos en una historia, que incluye exposición, acción ascendente, clímax y resolución.
Point of View	The perspective from which a story is told (first, second, or third person).	First-person: "I walked to the store."	Punto de Vista	La perspectiva desde la cual se cuenta una historia (primera, segunda o tercera persona).
Protagonist	The main character in a literary work.	Scout Finch in To Kill a Mockingbird.	Protagonista	El personaje principal en una obra literaria.

Repetition	The use of the same word or phrase multiple times for emphasis.	"Let it snow, let it snow, let it snow."	Repetición	El uso de la misma palabra o frase varias veces para énfasis.
Rhetorical Question	A question asked for effect, not meant to be answered.	"Is this the kind of world we want to live in?"	Pregunta Retórica	Una pregunta formulada para efecto, no destinada a ser respondida.
Setting	The time and place where a story takes place.	1920s New York in The Great Gatsby.	Ambientación	El tiempo y lugar en el que se desarrolla una historia.
Simile	A figure of speech comparing two unlike things using "like" or "as."	"Her smile was as bright as the sun."	Símil	Una figura retórica que compara dos cosas diferentes usando "como" o "tal cual".
Symbolism	The use of symbols to represent ideas or qualities.	A red rose representing love.	Simbolismo	El uso de símbolos para representar ideas o cualidades.
Theme	The underlying message or main idea of a text.	A theme of loyalty in The Kite Runner.	Tema	El mensaje subyacente o la idea principal de un texto.
Thesis	The main idea or argument in a piece of writing.	"Social media should be regulated to protect privacy."	Tesis	La idea principal o argumento en un texto escrito.
Tone	The author's attitude toward the subject.	A sarcastic tone in a satire.	Tono	La actitud del autor hacia el tema.

Understatement	A figure of speech in which something is made to seem less important or serious than it is.	"It's just a scratch," for a large wound.	Subestimación	Una figura retórica en la que algo se hace parecer menos importante o serio de lo que es.
Voice	The distinct style or personality of a writer or narrator.	Harper Lee's distinctive Southern voice in <i>To Kill a Mockingbird</i> .	Voz	El estilo o personalidad distintiva de un escritor o narrador.

Academic Vocabulary - Spanish

Word	Definition	Example	Spanish Word	Spanish Definition
Analyze	To examine something in detail to understand it better or to draw conclusions.	Analyzing the characters' motivations helps understand the story's theme.	Analizar	Examinar algo en detalle para entenderlo mejor o sacar conclusiones.
Argument	A reason or set of reasons given to persuade others that an action or idea is right or wrong.	Presenting an argument about the benefits of recycling in class discussions.	Argumento	Una razón o conjunto de razones dadas para persuadir a otros de que una acción o idea es correcta o incorrecta.
Articulate	To express an idea or feeling fluently and coherently.	He articulated his opinion on climate change clearly during the debate.	Articular	Expresar una idea o sentimiento de manera fluida y coherente.
Assess	To evaluate or estimate the nature, ability, or quality of something.	Teachers assess student essays to gauge their understanding of the topic.	Evaluar	Valorar o estimar la naturaleza, capacidad o calidad de algo.
Central Idea	The main point or message that an author is trying to convey in a text.	The central idea of the novel is the struggle for justice in a prejudiced society.	Idea Central	El punto principal o mensaje que un autor intenta transmitir en un texto.

Cite	To quote or reference a text or source as evidence to support an argument or claim.	When writing an essay, you must cite sources to support your arguments.	Citar	Citar o hacer referencia a un texto o fuente como evidencia para respaldar un argumento o reclamación.
Clarify	To make something clearer or easier to understand.	The teacher clarified the assignment instructions to help students understand.	Aclarar	Hacer algo más claro o más fácil de entender.
Compare	To examine two or more items to identify similarities and differences.	Comparing the themes of friendship in two different novels highlights their similarities.	Comparar	Examinar dos o más elementos para identificar similitudes y diferencias.
Contrast	To examine two or more items to identify differences.	Contrasting the characters' decisions shows how they respond to challenges differently.	Contrastar	Examinar dos o más elementos para identificar diferencias.
Critique	To evaluate or analyze something in a detailed and constructive manner.	In art class, students critique each other's work to provide feedback for improvement.	Criticar	Evaluar o analizar algo de manera detallada y constructiva.
Demonstrate	To show or prove something through evidence or examples.	The scientist demonstrated her findings with a well-organized presentation.	Demostrar	Mostrar o probar algo a través de evidencia o ejemplos.

Develop	To grow or cause to grow and become more mature, advanced, or elaborate.	Students develop their ideas into complete essays by providing supporting details.	Desarrollar	Crecer o causar que algo crezca y se vuelva más maduro, avanzado o elaborado.
Discuss	To talk about something with another person or group, often to exchange ideas or opinions.	In group discussions, students discuss different viewpoints on a current event.	Discutir	Hablar sobre algo con otra persona o grupo, a menudo para intercambiar ideas u opiniones.
Elaborate	To explain something in more detail or with more complexity.	The author elaborates on the setting to create a vivid picture in the reader's mind.	Elaborar	Explicar algo con más detalle o complejidad.
Evaluate	To assess the value or significance of something.	Students evaluate the credibility of sources when conducting research.	Evaluar	Valorar la importancia o el significado de algo.
Explain	To make an idea, situation, or problem clear by describing it in more detail.	She explained the steps in solving the equation to her classmates.	Explicar	Hacer clara una idea, situación o problema describiéndolo con más detalle.
Identify	To recognize and name someone or something.	Students identify the main character in a story by describing their traits.	Identificar	Reconocer y nombrar a alguien o algo.
Infer	To deduce or conclude information from	Readers can infer a character's feelings based	Inferir	Deducir o concluir información a partir de

	evidence rather than from explicit statements.	on their actions and dialogue.		evidencia en lugar de declaraciones explícitas.
Interpret	To explain the meaning of something or to make sense of something.	Interpreting a poem requires understanding the imagery and emotions conveyed.	Interpretar	Explicar el significado de algo o dar sentido a algo.
Justify	To provide reasons or evidence to support an action or decision.	In her essay, she justified her opinion with facts and examples from research.	Justificar	Proporcionar razones o evidencia para respaldar una acción o decisión.
Persuade	To convince someone to do or believe something through reasoning or argument.	He used logical reasoning to persuade his friends to join the study group.	Persuadir	Convencer a alguien de hacer o creer algo a través del razonamiento o argumento.
Propose	To put forward a plan or suggestion for consideration.	She proposed a new way to approach the group project during the meeting.	Proponer	Presentar un plan o sugerencia para consideración.
Summarize	To give a brief statement of the main points of something.	After reading, the students summarized the key events of the chapter.	Resumir	Dar una declaración breve sobre los puntos principales de algo.
Support	To provide evidence or arguments that uphold a claim or idea.	In her report, she supported her main argument with data from various studies.	Apoyar	Proporcionar evidencia o argumentos que respalden una reclamación o idea.

Synthesize	To combine different ideas or information to create a new understanding or perspective.	Students synthesize information from different texts to form a cohesive argument in their essays.	Sintetizar	Combinar diferentes ideas o información para crear una nueva comprensión o perspectiva.
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